

Goya

Through art that encapsulated the turbulence of late 18th and early 19th century Spain, Francisco de Goya (1746–1828) became known as the last Old Master and the first great modern artist. During his life, dramatic upheavals occurred across Europe, often triggered by power-hungry autocratic monarchs. Goya lived for 82 years and worked as an artist for more than 60 of them. As a commentator and chronicler of his era, he influenced generations of younger artists. His enigmatic images vividly capture Spain's changing fortunes in the 18th and 19th centuries, satirizing contemporary attitudes and events.

Appointed painter to Charles III and principal court painter to Charles IV of Spain, Goya also painted for the self-appointed King Joseph, Napoleon's brother, after the French invasion of Spain. Yet in 1792, a serious illness left him permanently deaf and he became introspective. His work expressed his insightful, sardonic thoughts about the problems of Spain and Europe, yet despite living in dangerous times, he was never called to account.



Goya, *The Third of May 1808*, 1814